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ICONIC RITUAL
The evening aarti at the Dashashwamedh Ghat in Varanasi, 2021

$ 22.9 BILLION
What Indians spent on outbound tourism in 2019

BANGLADESH INDIA'S NO. 1 MARKET IN TERMS OF FOREIGN TOURIST ARRIVALS FOR SEVERAL YEARS NOW

Pilgrim Power
50 million at 2019 Ardh Kumbh

In 2020, Tamil Nadu was the top state in domestic tourist arrivals (140.65 million) and No. 2 in foreign tourist arrivals (after Maharashtra) with 1.23 million visitors

1945 Govt forms **committee on Indian tourism**

1956 5th Plan takes up project of tourism development

1958 **Department of Tourism** established

1982 **National Policy on Tourism** adopted; Indian Railways and RTDC launch **Palace on Wheels**

2002 **Incredible !ndia** campaign launched

2021 **'Dekho Apna Desh'** campaign starts

2022 Taj Mahal becomes the **3rd most-viewed monument in the world** on Google Street View (after the Burj Khalifa and Eiffel Tower)